

Chapter 43 - Travel

Since that night, Yan Lin never appeared in front of Feng Yue again, and Feng Yue had no intention of actively seeking news about her. She attributed that night's incident to an accident—an accident like being bitten by a dog. Her life had to continue.

However, although Yan Lin never appeared again, the apologetic gifts sent by the Yan family to her home were plentiful.

Mother Yan probably considered Feng Yue's feelings and didn't visit in person, but instead had someone deliver the gifts she had prepared for Feng Yue.

Feng Yue had always had a good relationship with Mother Yan, so she didn't refuse the things Mother Yan sent, but simply had the maid store them in the storage room.

After Feng Yue moved back home, her life became monotonous and boring. All her video filming equipment was at Songhe Bay, and she couldn't film at home, so her video account had to stop updating.

The growth trend of her account became gradual, and so far it was close to breaking through one hundred thousand followers. She had previously promised everyone that she would give a special gift when she reached one hundred thousand followers, but Feng Yue had no idea what this gift should be.

A giveaway was necessary, but if it was only a giveaway, she felt it would be too monotonous. Fortunately, there was still some time, so she could think about it slowly.

Compared to the follower gift, what was immediately at hand was the Golden Week¹ trip she had planned with Wen Zhen and Zhou Qiongqiong.

Feng Yue couldn't go back to Songhe Bay now, so she had to make the snacks to bring along in her home kitchen.

The ingredients were purchased by the maid at her request and stored neatly in the refrigerator.

They would set off early tomorrow morning, with the three of them taking one car, so Wen Zhen would pick her up first, then they would pick up Zhou Qiongqiong.

Therefore, these snacks couldn't be made and taken on the same day—she needed to make these things a day in advance.

This wasn't Feng Yue's first time using the kitchen at home, but it was her first time making these kinds of small treats at home.

The maid and Mother Feng were both very curious, so while Feng Yue was busy in the kitchen, they watched from the side.

Mother Feng's cooking skills were basically non-existent, but she loved poking around the kitchen. If not for Father Feng and Feng Yue explicitly forbidding her from cooking, she would probably have become a real kitchen disaster.

"Nuan Nuan, why do you add milk powder when making egg yolk pastries? Won't that taste strange? If you ask me, you should add some chili powder in moderation—it would be appetizing." Mother Feng stuck her head out and couldn't help suggesting.

Feng Yue: ...

Egg yolk pastries and chili powder...

Feng Yue swallowed, completely unable to imagine what these two things would taste like together.

"Mom, egg yolk pastries are desserts. How can you add chili powder?"

Mother Feng coughed lightly to cover her embarrassment: "I was just talking casually."

"Nuan Nuan, turn down the heat over there. It looks like it's about to burn." The maid reminded from the side.

Feng Yue turned to look and indeed, she had been so busy chatting with her mom that she forgot the high heat was still on.

After quickly turning down the heat, Feng Yue kicked Mother Feng out of the kitchen, using the excuse that she would affect her performance.

Mother Feng couldn't argue with her, so she had to reluctantly leave the kitchen with the maid.

Finally, with no one to disturb her, Feng Yue began to concentrate on enjoying the pleasure of cooking, her movements becoming increasingly skillful.

Before long, hearing the crisp "ding" from the oven, the egg yolk pastries were ready.

The freshly baked egg yolk pastries and cookies were hot, fragrant, and crispy. Paired with the fruit tea that Feng Yue specially made, they were refreshing and cut through the richness.

Feng Yue made more this time than when filming videos, so she first brought some out to Mother Feng and the maid to taste, asking if they were different from last time.

Both lavishly praised Feng Yue's cooking skills, and Feng Yue felt relieved. She returned to the kitchen to pack everything in containers to take directly tomorrow.

Early the next morning, Wen Zhen's car stopped punctually at the entrance of the Feng family villa. She was about to notify Feng Yue that she had arrived when she saw the villa's main gate open and Feng Yue running over with bags in hand.

Seeing this, Wen Zhen quickly opened the car door and got out, putting the things Feng Yue was carrying into the trunk.

Wen Zhen was driving an SUV today, with spacious interior, specifically chosen to accommodate everything the three girls would bring.

"Sister Wen Zhen, good morning." Feng Yue's eyes were bright and sparkling, particularly dazzling in the morning breeze.

"Morning." Wen Zhen smiled, looking to be in a good mood. Looking at the things Feng Yue put in the trunk, she asked with some surprise: "You only brought this much? Aren't we playing for three days? These should be enough, right?"

Feng Yue was stunned: "Isn't this enough? We're only going for three days, right? These things should be sufficient."

"Yes, yes, it's definitely enough. I didn't bring much either." Wen Zhen thought of the photos Zhou Qiongqiong had sent her last night and silently sighed, hoping that Feng Yue wouldn't be scared when she saw Zhou Qiongqiong's luggage later.

"Ah Yue, have you had breakfast? If not, let's go eat something first before picking up Qiongqiong. If she hasn't eaten breakfast, we won't eat with her." Wen Zhen asked considerately.

"No, but I'm not very hungry. We can go pick up Qiongqiong directly."

However, Wen Zhen refused: "You haven't taken your morning medicine either, have you? It's not good to take medicine on an empty stomach. Let's find a breakfast shop and eat something casually."

Only after Wen Zhen's reminder did Feng Yue remember she still needed to take medicine, so she nodded.

She usually got up at nine in the morning and had breakfast and medicine directly. Today she forgot because it was too early, thankfully Wen Zhen reminded her.

The two got in the car, and Wen Zhen took Feng Yue to a Chinese breakfast shop. They couldn't eat too much greasy food in the morning, so they only ordered two bowls of corn porridge and a steamer of soup dumplings.

After the two had completely filled their stomachs, they set off for Zhou Qiongqiong's house.

When they were about to arrive, Wen Zhen had Feng Yue call Zhou Qiongqiong, so when they reached downstairs, Zhou Qiongqiong was also coming down the stairs with her suitcase.

Feng Yue got out of the car and looked at Zhou Qiongqiong's suitcase. She opened her mouth wanting to complain but didn't know where to start.

"Qiongqiong, isn't bringing such a big suitcase a bit exaggerated..." Feng Yue asked cautiously.

Zhou Qiongqiong was obviously struggling a bit to stuff the suitcase into the trunk, then sighed with relief: "How is it exaggerated? We're going for three days! I brought clothes and shoes to change for these three days, cosmetics and skincare products, a camera, and some miscellaneous things. So it's not that exaggerated."

Wen Zhen and Feng Yue, who only brought change of clothes: ...

"Alright, alright, don't stand here anymore. Let's go quickly. Although the resort isn't far, if we're any later we'll probably be stuck on the elevated highway." Saying this, Zhou Qiongqiong pushed the two toward the car.

Zhou Qiongqiong chose to sit in the back seat, reasoning that she still needed to touch up her makeup. The two had no choice but to sit back in the front seats.

Wen Zhen sat back in the driver's seat, and after fastening her seatbelt, she remembered something and turned to ask Zhou Qiongqiong: "By the way, where's the thing I asked you to bring?"

Only then did Zhou Qiongqiong remember, and she hurriedly searched through her bag.

Feng Yue also looked over curiously.

Zhou Qiongqiong carried a very large shoulder bag stuffed with makeup supplies she commonly used and various scattered small items.

Soon, she pulled out a smaller thermos from her bag, with their theater troupe's logo printed on it.

"Here, I followed your instructions and filled it with warm water." Zhou Qiongqiong handed the thermos to Wen Zhen.

Before Feng Yue and Zhou Qiongqiong could figure out why Wen Zhen wanted warm water, Wen Zhen handed the cup to Feng Yue.

"Take your medicine first. It should be about half an hour since we finished breakfast."

Feng Yue was stunned, pressed her lips together and blinked, then nodded dazedly.

Zhou Qiongqiong didn't know about Feng Yue's illness: "Ah Yue is sick? Why does she need medicine?"

"She said her stomach was uncomfortable this morning. We just went to the pharmacy to buy stomach medicine, which is why I asked you to bring some warm water down."

"Oh, oh, stomach discomfort is really uncomfortable. You should take the medicine quickly." After saying this, Zhou Qiongqiong shrank back to continue looking in the mirror.

Feng Yue admired Wen Zhen's smooth lying skills, and felt warmth flowing into her heart like a stream from Wen Zhen's thoughtful care.

"Take it now. You might choke if the car starts moving later." Wen Zhen reminded gently again.

Feng Yue came back to her senses and quickly nodded: "Yes!" Then she took out her medicine from her bag and swallowed it with the warm water from the thermos.

This was the first time the three of them went out together, and Zhou Qiongqiong's first time traveling with Wen Zhen. This twenty-something woman was as happy as an elementary school student on a field trip.

However, Zhou Qiongqiong's energy only lasted a while. Before even half an hour passed, she was leaning against the back seat, asleep.

Feng Yue turned to look at her, reached out to pull out a small blanket from the back seat cushions to cover her, then turned back and lowered the volume of the stereo.

"Is she asleep?" Wen Zhen glanced at the rearview mirror.

"Yes, I noticed the dark circles under her eyes when I first saw her today. She probably stayed up late last night." Feng Yue speculated.

"Mm, she was still packing her suitcase until after midnight and sent me photos to look at."

"So you were also up after midnight and didn't sleep? Did you have insomnia?"

Wen Zhen was speechless—how did she accidentally expose herself?

Seeing her silence, Feng Yue smiled and asked: "Sister Wen Zhen, you weren't too excited to sleep, were you?"

Wen Zhen coughed lightly and helplessly smiled, nodding: "Yes, that's exactly it."

Feng Yue sighed deeply and leaned back against her chair: "Ah, I didn't expect you'd also lose sleep from excitement."

Wen Zhen caught the word "also" in her statement and asked: "So you couldn't sleep either?"

"That's right!" Feng Yue turned to look at her, eyes bright and sparkling, her voice unable to hide her excitement: "This is my first time going on a vacation with friends for more than two days."

"As long as you're willing, we'll have many more opportunities in the future. We can even go farther, not limited to domestic travel."

Feng Yue's eyes were full of longing, but after thinking about it she said: "We two always have time, but it's not easy for Qiongqiong to get leave. Near the end of the year, the theater troupe should have more performances."

Wen Zhen, who had only planned for the two of them: ...

But she could only reluctantly nod in agreement: "Indeed."

After saying this, looking at Zhou Qiongqiong sleeping soundly in the back seat, she sighed almost imperceptibly.

Footnotes:

¹ 黄金周 (Golden Week) - A week-long national holiday in China, typically referring to either the National Day holiday (October 1-7) or Chinese New Year holiday period, when many people travel.